

State of the Web

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols & Security

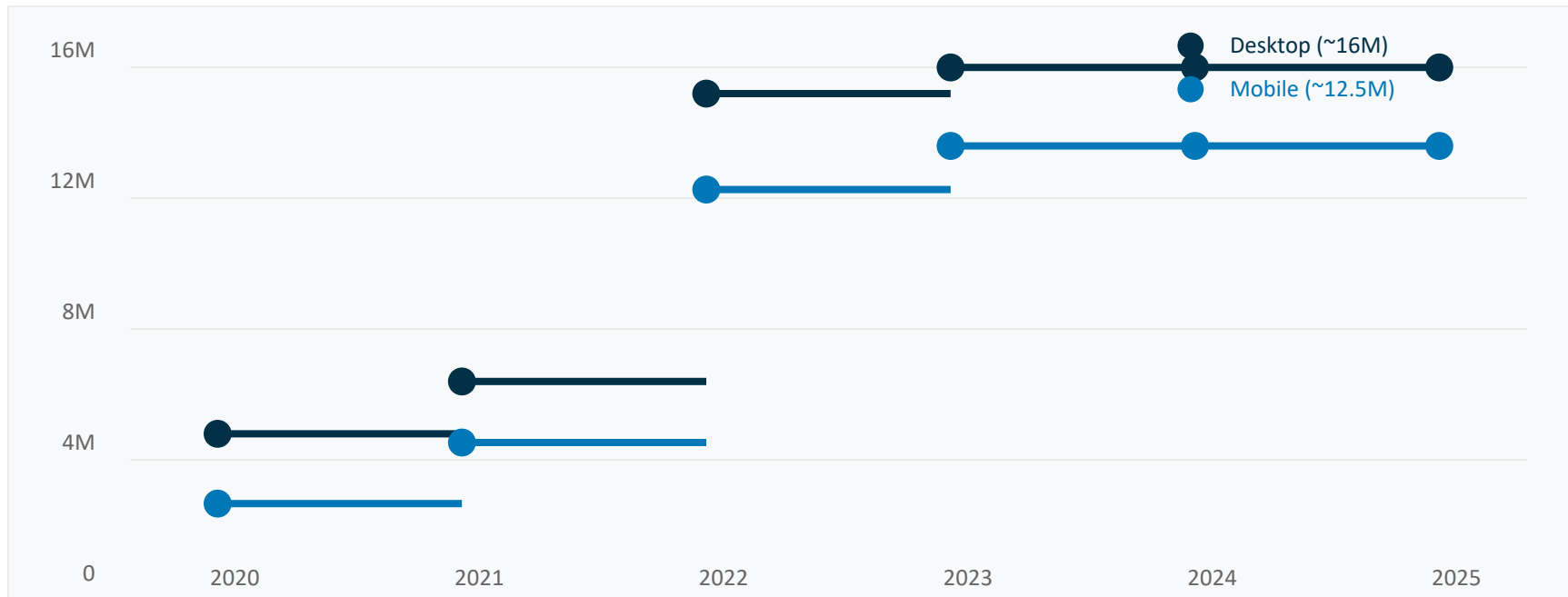
Source: HTTP Archive — State of the Web Report

Period: January 2020 – March 2026

Web Performance Engineers & Architects

Crawl Sample Size Tripled

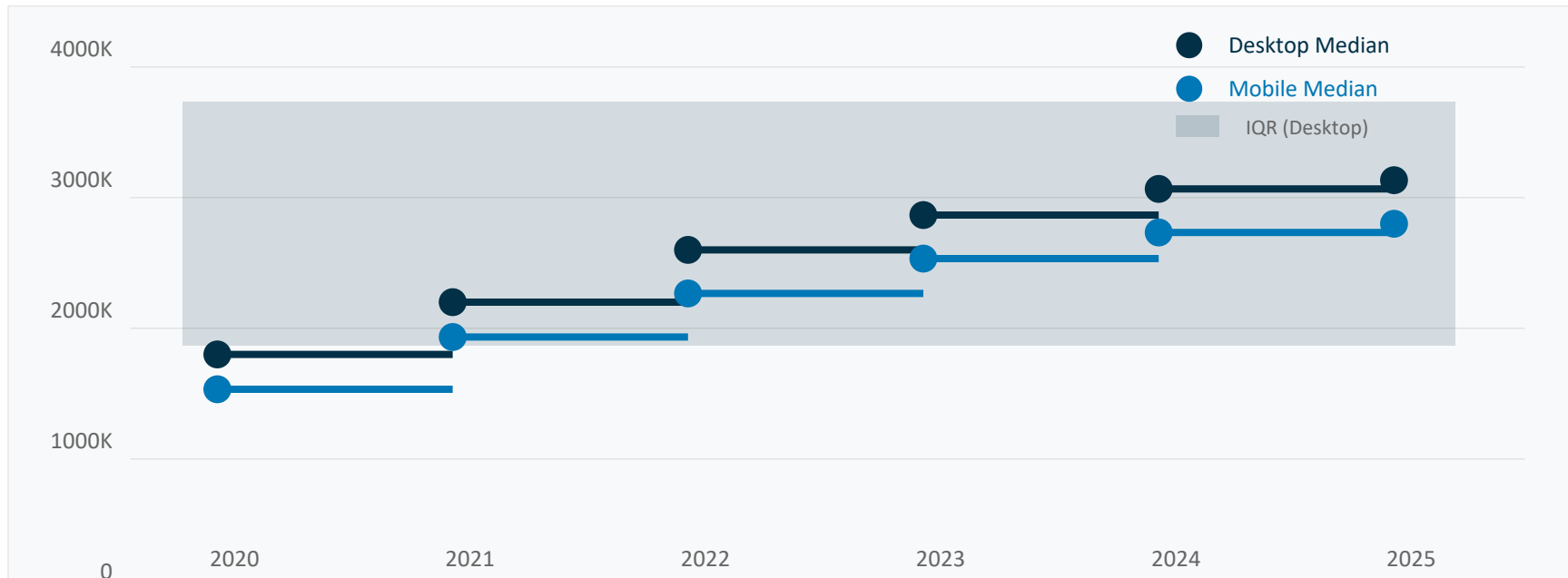
Desktop URL count grew from ~5M to 16M since 2020



Sharp jump around mid-2022 — sample has stabilized at 16M desktop / 12.5M mobile

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size over 5 years — Desktop vs Mobile with interquartile range



~2,000 KB

Desktop Median

~1,900 KB

Mobile Median

▲ ~25%

Growth Since 2020

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

More requests but fewer connections — multiplexing efficiency gains from HTTP/2 & HTTP/3

76

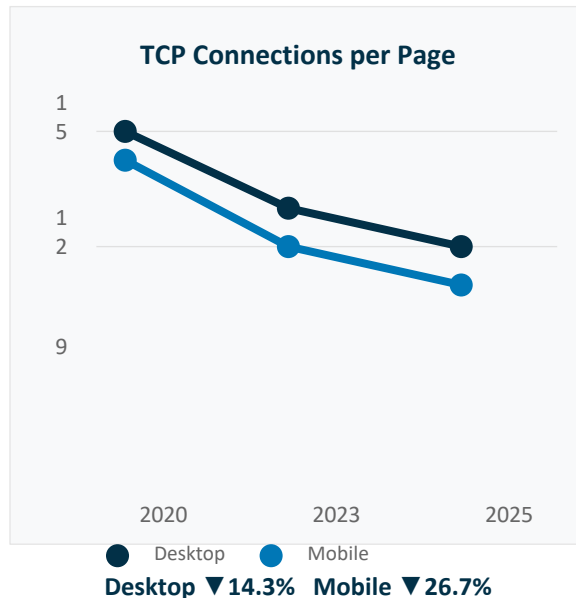
Desktop Requests

▲ 2.7% vs 2020

71

Mobile Requests

▲ 2.9% vs 2020



HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing enables more requests over fewer connections — efficiency improved 15-27%

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

Unencrypted HTTP effectively extinct on the modern web

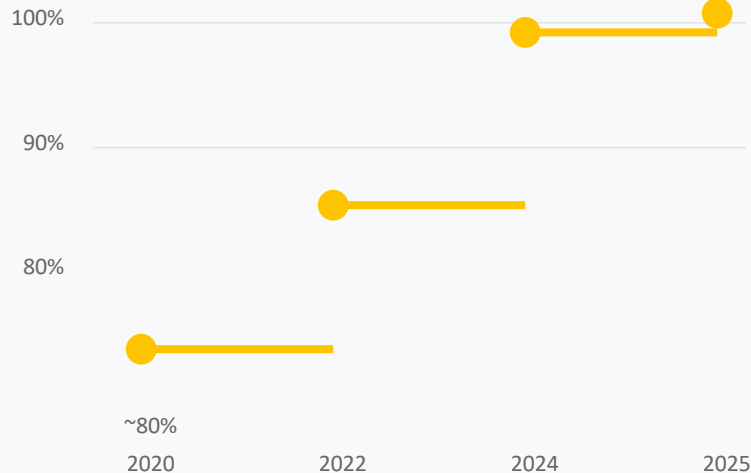
99%+

Desktop: 99.2%

Mobile: 99.1%

▲ ~19-20% since 2020

HTTPS Adoption Over Time



Plaintext HTTP is now a legacy protocol — HTTPS is the baseline for all modern web traffic

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing protocol metric; HTTP/2 remains dominant but stable

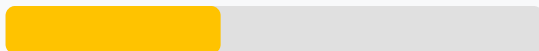
Current Protocol Distribution

HTTP/2



58.6% desktop / 57.6% mobile

HTTP/3



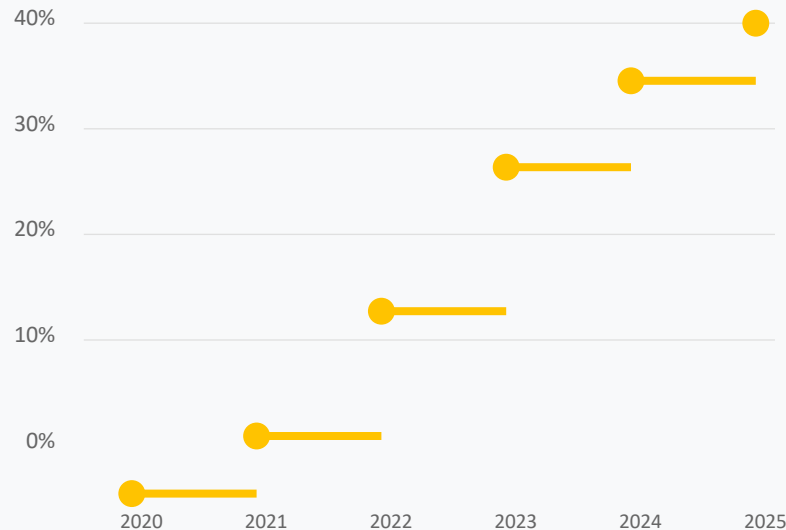
38.7% desktop / 40.0% mobile

HTTP/3 Growth vs 2020

+38,600%
Desktop

+5,614%
Mobile

HTTP/3 Support Growth



Note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (via Alt-Svc headers), not active usage

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) avoidance still has significant room for growth

40.1%

Desktop Adoption

▲ 14.9% since 2020

42.5%

Mobile Adoption

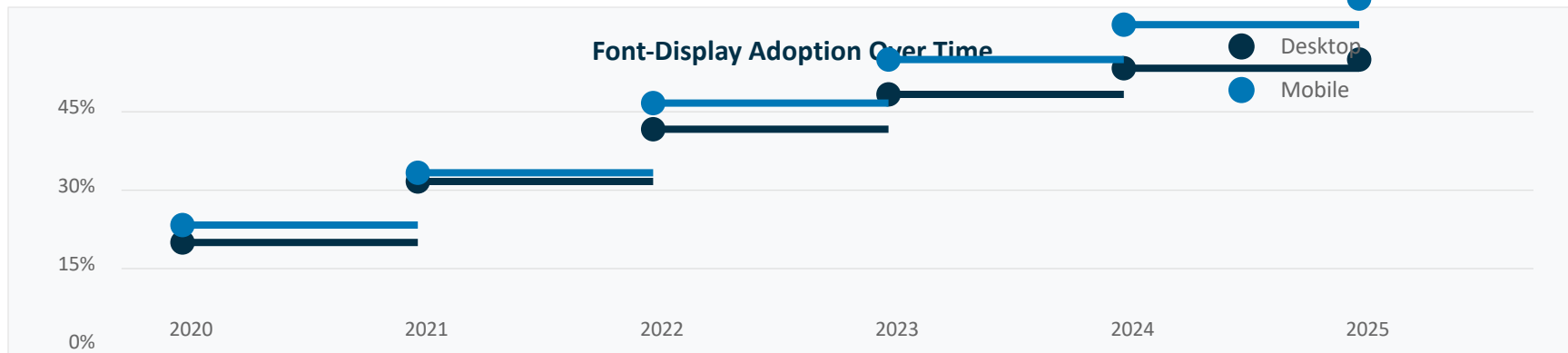
▲ 61.0% since 2020

Growth

61%

Mobile leads in growth

vs 14.9% desktop



Key Takeaways

State of the Web 2020–2025: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

01

Page weight continues to grow

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript

02

HTTPS is now the baseline

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web

03

HTTP/3 is the fastest-growing metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years — explosive growth driven by browser and server adoption

04

TCP connections declining via multiplexing

HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing cut median connections per page by 15–27%, improving network efficiency despite more requests

05

Font-display still underused

Benchmark your sites against these baselines to prioritize optimization efforts